

**UNIT
14**

POEM

UNIT 14 POEMS

THE NEEM TREE

This poem was written by **Mrs. Elsa Kazi**, the German wife of Allama I.I. Kazi, the late vice-chancellor of the University of Sindh. She was born at Weimar in Germany. She met Allama I.I. Kazi in 1907 in London and in 1910 was married to him. They came to Sindh in 1911 where she spent the rest of her life, visiting Europe now and then. She wrote poems in German and English and also helped her husband in writing his book "Brown Girl in Search of God." She died in Hyderabad on May 28, 1967, and is buried beside her husband at the Sindh University Campus, Jamshoro.

My lovely Neem,
That intercepts sun's scorching beam,
Yet bears the heat all day
Without the rain's refreshing spray,
Thou charm'st the wanderer's woe away
With soothing shade.
How strong you are, how unafraid,
How green thy leaves in spite of all
The mid-day flames that burning fall
Upon thy unprotected head...
Could man be bold as thou and rise
Above the earth, with the sheltering arm
To save the suffering ones from harm,
From sorrows, poverty and vice
Through sacrifice.
Could man be steadfast, and like thee
Face every fate, would it not be
Fulfilment of life's loftiest dream.
My lovely Neem!



1. Comprehension Questions

- What qualities of the neem tree does the poetess admire?
- How does the poetess describe the neem tree's ability to endure harsh conditions?
- Why does the poetess compare human strength to that of the neem tree?
- What message does the poetess convey about sacrifice and facing challenges?
- How does the neem tree symbolize protection and resilience in the poem?

2. Vocabulary Building

- **Define the following words and use in your sentences.**

Intercepts, Scorching, Unafraid, Steadfast, Poverty

3. Discussion Question

- The poet admires the neem tree's strength and resilience. Can you think of a time in your life when you had to be strong and face challenges without giving up? How did that experience change you?

THE ROAD NOT TAKEN

Robert Frost (1874–1963) was an American poet known for his deep and insightful poetry about nature, life, and human choices. He was born in San Francisco but spent most of his life in New England, which influenced his poetry. Frost's poems often explore rural life and philosophical themes with simple yet powerful language.

Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
And sorry I could not travel both
And be one traveler, long I stood
And looked down one as far as I could
To where it bent in the undergrowth;

Then took the other, as just as fair,
And having perhaps the better claim,
Because it was grassy and wanted wear;
Though as for that the passing there
Had worn them really about the same,

And both that morning equally lay
In leaves no step had trodden black.
Oh, I kept the first for another day!
Yet knowing how way leads on to way,
I doubted if I should ever come back.

I shall be telling this with a sigh
Somewhere ages and ages hence:
Two roads diverged in a wood, and I—
I took the one less traveled by,
And that has made all the difference.



1. Comprehension Questions

- What decision does the speaker face in the poem?
- Why does the speaker choose the road "less traveled by"?
- How does the speaker feel about the choice made?

2. Vocabulary Building

- **Define:** diverged, undergrowth, trodden, sigh,
- Use each word in a sentence.

3. Discussion Question

- Have you ever had to make a difficult choice in your life? What influenced your decision, and how did it turn out?

4. Creative Task

- Draw an illustration of the two roads described in the poem.
- Write a short paragraph about a time you made a unique choice and how it impacted your life.

STOPPING BY WOODS ON A SNOWY EVENING

"Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" by **Robert Frost** is one of his most famous poems. It portrays a peaceful winter scene but also carries a deeper meaning about responsibilities and life's journey. The famous lines "And miles to go before I sleep" suggest duty and commitments that must be fulfilled before one can rest.

Whose woods these are I think I know.
His house is in the village though;
He will not see me stopping here
To watch his woods fill up with snow.

My little horse must think it queer
To stop without a farmhouse near
Between the woods and frozen lake
The darkest evening of the year.

He gives his harness bells a shake
To ask if there is some mistake.
The only other sound's the sweep
Of easy wind and downy flake.

The woods are lovely, dark and deep,
But I have promises to keep,
And miles to go before I sleep,
And miles to go before I sleep.



1. Comprehension Questions

- Why does the speaker stop by the woods?
- How does the horse react to stopping in the woods?
- What are the only sounds the speaker hears in the woods?
- What does the speaker mean by "The woods are lovely, dark and deep"?
- Why does the speaker repeat the line "And miles to go before I sleep"?

2. Vocabulary Building

- **Define the following words and use in your sentences:**

Harness, Queer, Flake, Sweep

3. Discussion Question

- The speaker in the poem is tempted to stay in the peaceful woods but reminds himself of his duties. Can you think of a time when you had to put responsibilities before something enjoyable? How did it feel?